

Monday, 7 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Drizzle	Rain	Drizzle
23° 18°	21° 15°	20° 15°	17° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Thousands of job cuts are expected at Jaguar Land Rover, with a minister set to meet the company's boss to discuss the situation.

The car manufacturer is reportedly struggling with the impact of tariffs and the fallout from a major cyber attack last year. This news comes as a significant concern for the UK automotive industry.

ECONOMY · UK
- 2

Police were slow to respond to a protest in Dover, according to the local council boss, who said the event caught agencies off guard.

The protest was described as 'exceptionally well organised,' highlighting potential issues with preparedness. This raises questions about public order management in the area.

PUBLIC ORDER · UK
- 3

Jamaica is set to present a slavery reparations petition directly to King Charles, asking him to refer it to the Privy Council.

This move highlights ongoing discussions around historical injustices and calls for redress. It will likely spark significant debate and attention.

HISTORY · UK
- 4

A staggering 140 migrants in a single dinghy were rescued in the English Channel over the weekend, a record number for one vessel.

They were transferred to lifeboats and brought ashore in the UK, underscoring the continuing challenges of Channel crossings. This incident will intensify the debate around migration policies.

MIGRATION · UK
- 5

The Reform UK party has faced a turbulent weekend, with two senior officials stepping down following a Channel 4 investigation.

This comes as the party held its conference, and a political commentator suggested it was 'not what Farage wanted today to look like.' It's a significant setback for the party.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Comedian Munya Chawawa is making a surprising leap from social media to the stage, preparing for his Shakespearean acting debut.**

He's expressed a desire to move away from creating online content, suggesting a new chapter in his career. It's an unexpected move for the popular comedian.

ON AIR – What do you think of Munya Chawawa's move into Shakespeare? Will he be a natural?

THEATRE · COMING UP
- 2 Speculation is building that an announcement about the next James Bond could be imminent, thrilling fans worldwide.**

With Daniel Craig's successor yet to be named, the anticipation is at an all-time high. Everyone is eager to know who will take on the iconic 007 role.

ON AIR – Who do you think should be the next James Bond? Is there a clear favourite?

FILM · COMING UP
- 3 Boy band star JJ Hamblett is swapping the stage for the racecourse, taking part in a charity horse race this week.**

The singer will be competing at Doncaster Racecourse on September 11th. It's a different kind of performance for the pop star.

ON AIR – Which other celebrities do you know who have surprised us with their sporting talents?

CHARITY · THIS WEEK
- 4 A new trio has taken the wheel of 'The Grand Tour', hoping to prove critics wrong as they step into Jeremy Clarkson's shoes.**

The motoring TV show has a fresh lineup of presenters, ready to embark on new adventures. It's a big challenge to follow such established names.

ON AIR – Are you excited for the new Grand Tour presenters? Can they live up to the original trio?

TV · COMING UP
- 5 Pulp are set to headline the 20th End of the Road Festival, promising a memorable performance for 15,000 visitors.**

The popular band will top the bill at the festival near Blandford Forum. It's a significant milestone for the event and a treat for fans.

ON AIR – Are you a Pulp fan? What's your favourite Pulp song to hear live?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1 **Mercedes' Kimi Antonelli secured a stunning victory at the Italian Grand Prix, fighting back from 19th on the grid.**

It was a breathtaking and incident-packed race at Monza, with Antonelli delivering an incredible performance. This win will be a huge confidence boost for the young driver.

ON AIR – What an incredible drive from Antonelli! Do you think he's a future world champion?

F1 · INTERNATIONAL

2 **Sophia Dunkley's century helped England sweep Ireland 3-0, ending their international summer with a dominant win.**

Dunkley hit 119 runs as England thrashed Ireland by 114 runs at Worcester. It was a fantastic way to conclude their season.

ON AIR – What's been your highlight of England's international cricket summer?

CRICKET · UK

3 **Former Leicester City and England striker Jamie Vardy has joined Burnley on a season-long contract.**

The veteran forward will play for Burnley until the end of the season. It's a big move for Vardy and an exciting signing for Burnley.

ON AIR – Do you think Jamie Vardy will be a good signing for Burnley? Can he still perform at the top level?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Britain's Eilish McColgan made a triumphant return to competitive action, winning the London Big Half for a fourth time.**

She had been out for five months with a broken toe, making her victory even more impressive. It's a fantastic comeback for the athlete.

ON AIR – What an amazing comeback for Eilish McColgan! Have you ever returned to a sport after a long injury lay-off?

ATHLETICS · UK

5 **Belgium's Tim Wellens has won the 2026 Tour of Britain, with Great Britain's Askey finishing second overall.**

Nils Politt claimed victory on the final stage, but it was Wellens who secured the overall title. It was a strong showing from the British rider too.

ON AIR – Are you a cycling fan? Did you follow the Tour of Britain this year?

CYCLING · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A delightful new trend sees people crafting 'miniature gardens' inside teacups and other small containers.**
These tiny horticultural wonders are becoming popular as charming desk decorations and unique gifts, bringing a touch of nature to small spaces.
- 2 Many are rediscovering the joy of 'letter writing', sending thoughtful notes to friends and family.**
In a world of instant messages, the personal touch of a handwritten letter is proving to be a cherished way to connect and express sentiments.
- 3 The humble 'picnic blanket' is getting a stylish upgrade, with designers offering luxurious and eco-friendly options.**
No longer just for practicality, picnic blankets are now fashion statements, encouraging more al-fresco dining in parks and gardens.
- 4 A fascinating study suggests that 'listening to birdsong' can significantly reduce stress levels.**
Researchers found that even short periods of exposure to natural bird sounds had a calming effect, improving mood and concentration.
- 5 The art of 'patchwork and quilting' is experiencing a vibrant revival among crafters.**
People are embracing this traditional craft to create beautiful, unique textiles, from intricate wall hangings to cosy blankets.
- 6 More people are enjoying 'foraging for wild edibles' in their local countryside and woodlands.**
With expert guidance, enthusiasts are discovering delicious natural ingredients, adding a unique flavour to their home cooking.
- 7 A new appreciation for 'vintage board games' is bringing families together for retro fun.**
Classic games from decades past are being dusted off and enjoyed, sparking nostalgia for older generations and curiosity for younger ones.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cereal will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: POURING A TINY BIT INTO OUR HAND TO SEE IF IT MAKES A GOOD 'CRACKLE' SOUND!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot cup of coffee, especially if it's a new blend. What is it?

ANSWER: TAKING A DEEP SNIFF OF THE STEAM THREE TIMES BEFORE THE FIRST SIP, 'JUST TO PREPARE THE SENSES'!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of weather' just instantly puts you in a good mood, or brings back a happy memory?

What's that one weather condition that, no matter what, just makes you feel happy or nostalgic, and why?

- We all have that 'one gadget or appliance' in our home that we absolutely couldn't do without, don't we?

What's that one piece of household tech or an appliance you'd genuinely miss the most if it suddenly stopped working, and what makes it so indispensable?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that some species of jellyfish are biologically immortal, meaning they can revert to an earlier stage of life after reaching maturity?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's said that the sound of a blooming flower can be heard by humans if they listen closely enough, especially on a very still morning.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£7.7 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£7.7 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first successful photograph was taken by Nicéphore Niépce in 1826 or 1827.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The 'cat's purr' has been shown to have healing properties, helping to lower blood pressure and reduce stress.
- The famous 'Big Ben' clock tower in London is actually named Elizabeth Tower, with Big Ben referring only to the massive bell inside.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The 'shortest war' in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on 27 August 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- More people are killed each year by 'falling coconuts' than by sharks.
- The longest river in the United Kingdom is the River Severn, at approximately 220 miles long.

On this day

Day 250 of the year, 115 days left in 2026. Today Air Force Day (Pakistan); Christian feast day: Anastasius the Fuller; Christian feast day: Clodoald; Christian feast day: Blessed Giovanni Battista Mazzucconi. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1992 — Miniminter, English YouTuber
- 1942 — Alan Oakes, English footballer and manager
- 1943 — Joe Simon, American singer-songwriter and producer, and preacher (died 2021)
- 1943 — Gloria Gaynor, American singer-songwriter
- 1961 — LeRoi Moore, American saxophonist and songwriter (died 2008)
- 1999 — Gracie Abrams, American singer-songwriter
- 1939 — Latimore, American singer-songwriter and pianist (died 2026)
- 1980 — J. D. Pardo, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1953 — Nikita Khrushchev is elected first secretary of the Communist Party of the Soviet Union.
- 1963 — The Pro Football Hall of Fame opens in Canton, Ohio with 17 charter members.
- 2017 — The 8.2 Mw 2017 Chiapas earthquake strikes southern Mexico, killing at least 60 people.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1997 — Maiden flight of the Lockheed Martin F-22 Raptor.
- 2010 — A Chinese fishing trawler collides with two Japanese Coast Guard patrol boats in disputed waters near the Senkaku Islands.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1986 — Chilean dictator Augusto Pinochet survives an assassination attempt by the FPMR; five of Pinochet's bodyguards are killed.
- 1979 — The Chrysler Corporation asks the United States government for US\$1.5 billion to avoid bankruptcy.

- 1970 — Fighting begins between Arab guerrillas and government forces in Jordan.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 251 of the year, 114 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Adrian and Natalia of Nicomedia (Roman Catholic Church); Christian Feast Day: Corbinian; Christian Feast Day: Disibod; Christian Feast Day: Blessed Frédéric Ozanam. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1934 — Bernard Donoughue, Baron Donoughue, English academic and politician
- 1994 — Nicky Walker, English professional footballer
- 1969 — Chris Powell, English footballer and manager
- 1968 — Ray Wilson, Scottish singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1942 — Brian Cole, American bass player (died 1972)
- 1994 — Stuart Moore, English professional footballer
- 1990 — Jos Buttler, English cricketer
- 1939 — Guitar Shorty, American singer and guitarist (died 2022)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2016 — NASA launches OSIRIS-REx, its first asteroid sample return mission. The probe visited 101955 Bennu and returned with samples in September 2023.
- 1970 — Trans International Airlines Flight 863 crashes during takeoff from John F. Kennedy International Airport in New York City, killing all 11 aboard.
- 2004 — NASA's uncrewed spacecraft Genesis crash-lands when its parachute fails to open.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1975 — Gays in the military: US Air Force Tech Sergeant Leonard Matlovich, a decorated veteran of the Vietnam War, appears in his Air Force uniform on the cover of Time magazine with the headline "I Am A Homosexual". He is given a general discharge, later upgraded to honorable.
- 2025 — Balçova police station shooting: 4 people, including the perpetrator are killed an attack on a police station in Turkey.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar